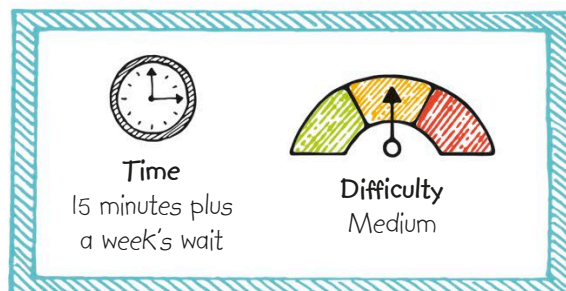
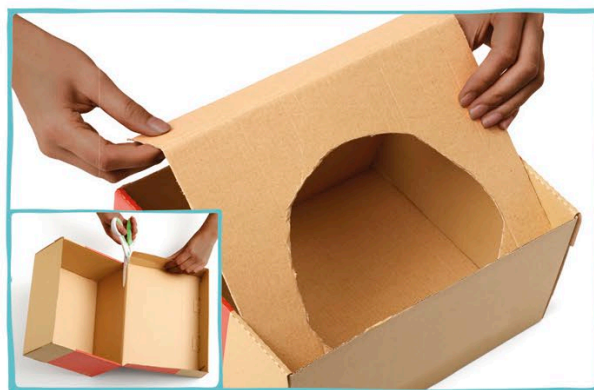


HOW TO MAKE A STUNNING STALACTITE

Don't throw away the box those new shoes came in because it will make a great cave. To make a stalactite, you need a white mineral powder, magnesium sulfate (commonly called Epsom salt), which most pharmacies stock. It takes at least a week for a stalactite to form, so be patient. And remember: don't put Epsom salt in your mouth, and wash your hands after touching it. The mineral isn't poisonous, but it can upset your stomach.



WHAT YOU NEED



1 If the box has an attached lid, cut it off. Then cut out a round hole in the lid—this makes the cave opening. Now trim the lid, so that it fits snugly in the box. Make a note of the side of the box you want to be the top of the cave.



2 Next, make a slit in the top of the box, about $\frac{1}{2}$ in (1cm) wide and 6 in (15cm) long, though this will depend on the size of your box. Soon, you will make the string dangle through this opening.